

and BJYM worker Praveen Nettaru (Karnataka, 2022)

2017

NIA submits a report to MHA, suggesting a ban on PFI for its alleged terror-related activities.

In a sting operation conducted by India Today TV, Zainaba A.S., the then head of PFI's women's wing, admits that its sister organisation Sathya Sarani runs an elaborate conversion operation. Ahmed Shareef, a PFI founding member, admits that the organisation aims to create an Islamic State

2018

The ED begins its probe against the PFI and its affiliate Rehab India Foundation on charges of money laundering

2019-2021

Intelligence agencies claim the PFI instigated **protests against the Citizenship Amendment Act** (CAA) in 2019-20 and farmers' agitation in 2020-2021

2020

The PFI's role in the Northeast Delhi riots in Feb. comes under the scanner with the arrest of five of its leaders

Mar. 2020

One of the bombers who attacked a gurudwara in Kabul, Afghanistan, killing 25 people, is reported to be a PFI member from Kerala

Oct. 2020

Members of the PFI and its student wing arrested in Mathura; police say they were headed to Hathras "to disturb communal harmony" after a Dalit woman's gangrape and murder

Dec. 2020

Seventeen PFI activists held in Karnataka for their role in August riots that left four dead

2021

Accused of fomenting violence in Assam's Darrang and unrest in MP's Malwa region

Feb. 2021

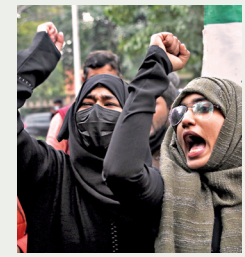
ED charges PFI for collecting Rs 1.36 cr. to fund the anti-CAA protests, Delhi riots, Hathras protests



(Left) Athar Parvez; Md Jalaluddin

2022

Karnataka government tells the apex court that students behind the **hijab row** were influenced by the PFI



Apr. 2022

The radical outfit is suspected to be behind communal violence in Rajasthan's Karauli and Madhya Pradesh's Khargone in April

May-Jun. 2022

Kerala Police arrest two PFI activists in May on charges of fomenting communal tension; three activists held for Kanpur violence in June



Jun. 2022

The NIA claims that the two men who killed Udaipur tailor **Kanhaiya Lal** on June 28, for his social media post in support of suspended BJP leader Nupur Sharma who had made an objectionable remark against the Prophet, had links with the PFI

Jul. 2022

The Telangana police arrest a 52-year-old karate instructor associated with the PFI. He was allegedly training Muslim youth for violent anti-social activities, including stone pelting, rioting, and murder

Jul. 2022

A former Jharkhand cop among three **PFI members arrested in Patna** between July 11 and 14. An eight-page document with an alleged plan to "establish rule of Islam in India by 2047" recovered from them

Kerala where Muslims account for 26.1 per cent of the state's 33.4 million population. "They announced a hartal and executed it within 10 hours braving police warnings and high court directives. Only the CPI(M) and the BJP can manage such flash hartals in Kerala within such a short time. It indicates the massive base the PFI has in Kerala," says K.M. Antony, a retired IPS officer and former superintendent of police (intelligence wing).

Indeed, its violent responses to critical situations has led to PFI's notoriety as an "Islamist extremist group". It has been under the scrutiny of government agencies for long in connection with incidents of alleged incitement of communal violence, hate campaigns, forced conversions, disappearance of youngsters who went on to join the Islamic State in Afghanistan and Syria and tit-for-tat murders of BJP/ RSS and CPI(M) leaders in Kerala.

The NIA also claims that the outfit had squads of trainers for making crude bombs and IEDs, and an intelligence wing and action squads to run its campaign of violence. It also runs centres for religious classes and martial arts training. This July, the Telangana police arrested a 52-year-old Karate instructor from Nizamabad in Hyderabad who was allegedly training Muslim youth to foment anti-social activities. The NIA has now taken over this investigation too.